

CROP CARE

Hoe regularly between the planted rows to control weeds and promote good air circulation. This also reduces the risk of pests and diseases (see opposite).

Keep your plants well watered and do not let the soil dry out—salad crops have a very shallow root system, so require frequent watering. Lack of moisture will spoil the flavor and texture of salad greens and encourages the plant to bolt. In hot weather, water either in the early morning or evening to avoid scorching the delicate leaves.

Many salad crops appreciate top-dressing with a nitrogen-rich fertilizer, which can be applied around the base of the plants. Apply fertilizer when growth



Harvest your greens using scissors.

appears to be slowing down; check the requirements of individual crops before using.

Plants sown outside in early spring may need protection if there is an exceptionally cold spell. Keep an eye on the weather and be prepared to cover your crops with fleece or cloches if the temperature drops.

TIP GROWING IN CONTAINERS

In a small garden, salad greens can be container-grown successfully on the patio or beside the kitchen door.

- Water plants regularly and take care not to let containers either dry out or become waterlogged.
- Make sure you choose the best position for your containers. Once filled, large pots are heavy to move.
- Raise containers on blocks or feet to improve drainage.



With their shallow roots, most salad greens will happily grow in a container.